CLARITY. CONTINUITY. CONTROL.

Nexus operating manual

Practical procedures for confident daily operation. Choose the task, check the prerequisites, follow the steps and verify the result.

This edition

11 modules / 23 procedures / Reviewed 2026-10-30

Your assigned section determines which modules you can open. Your role, record state and operation-specific gates determine what you can do.

Read the environment, record identity, scope and last successful update before acting. A stale snapshot or missing signal is not a healthy/empty system.

Guidance links only navigate. They never approve, execute, requeue, delete or change configuration.

After a write, verify the saved result and custody/history. If completion is uncertain, inspect the existing outcome before retrying.

Downloads are dated reference copies. Protect operational/customer information and use the current in-app guide after a deployment.

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NEXUS

Fabric overview

Read the fabric's current posture and move into the correct investigation.

Where to go: /nexus

Access and authority

Fabric overview access. Each Nexus workspace also has its own entitlement.

01 / Orient yourself in Nexus

Before you begin: Know the environment or affected business journey.

1. Check freshness and scope

Open Nexus. Read the overview and refresh state. Use search to locate incidents, services, clusters, flows or dependencies.

2. Choose the right workspace

Use Incidents for current/unresolved cases, Services for runtime evidence and controls, and Clusters/Flows/Dependencies for relationships. Linked Stats and Network Sentinel consoles require their own access.

3. Separate facts from inference

Read source timestamps and evidence before acting on a root-cause suggestion. An unavailable source is not healthy and a likely cause is not a confirmed verdict.

How to confirm success

You know which workspace holds the evidence and which service/incident to inspect.

Stop and check

Do not execute controls from a summary alone. Open the detailed evidence and relevant procedure.

Something is blocking you?

Workspace missing

Ask the section administrator to check that specific module; the overview does not grant all Nexus operations.

Terms in plain language

Fabric

The catalog of services, their relationships and operational evidence.

Correlation

Combining signals to propose a shared incident or cause.

Procedure reference: nexus.dashboard / 2026-10-30

NEXUS

Incident investigation

Investigate impact, gather evidence, coordinate response and record a verified outcome.

Where to go: /nexus?workspace=incidents

Access and authority

Incident investigation access; diagnostics, tasks, verdicts and notification settings remain role-gated.

01 / Investigate an incident

Before you begin: Identify the affected journey/service and incident time.

1. Choose a case

In Incidents, use All unresolved, Active now, Shift pulse, Last 24h or Older. Open Incident Command View. Restored cases can still await an operator verdict.

2. Read the evidence

Review Overview, Topology and Evidence. Compare suspected root, confidence, affected services, timeline and business-flow scope. Inspect original evidence when a mapped link is available.

3. Request assistance

Use Request Diagnostics if allowed, then inspect the resulting Actions/evidence. Create Response Task for owned follow-up. SOP Copilot can explain/cite procedures; verify the cited version and prerequisites.

How to confirm success

The response is based on dated evidence, with assigned follow-up where needed.

Stop and check

Confidence is a hypothesis score, not certainty. Missing deep-link mapping should be corrected in the catalog, not guessed.

02 / Record an operator verdict

Before you begin: Have verified the cause and whether the action worked.

1. Review the restored state

Compare current signal and the incident end time. Confirm whether impact ended and identify remaining work.

2. Record the outcome

Open Outcome. Supply the supported verdict, actual root/cause, action result and explanation required by the form. Submit once and confirm the recorded learning/closure state.

How to confirm success

The incident carries an attributable human outcome, not just automatic recovery.

Stop and check

Do not confirm a root cause merely because it was Nexus's top candidate.

03 / Configure incident notification delivery

Before you begin: Have Admin authority and an approved recipient/channel scope.

1. Open Notification Mesh

Choose Configure. Review active-shift recipient scope, channels, extra email recipients and last delivery/queue state.

2. Save and inspect delivery

Set the approved controls, save, then inspect subsequent delivery status and failures. Extra recipients must be intentional.

How to confirm success

The mesh shows the saved scope and evidence of delivery attempts.

Stop and check

In-app or email delivery status does not prove a person read the message. Desktop browser alerts require supported HTTPS permission.

Something is blocking you?

Diagnostics/action fails

Read the returned error and Actions record; do not repeat disruptive commands.

No evidence link

Open the correct service contract and have its Network Sentinel mapping verified.

Terms in plain language

Awaiting verdict

Impact may have ended, but human investigation closure is still pending.

Blast radius

The services or journeys inferred to be affected.

Procedure reference: nexus.incidents / 2026-10-30

NEXUS

Service catalog and controls

Inspect a service's live evidence and manage its governed contract and controls.

Where to go: /nexus?workspace=services

Access and authority

Service catalog access; catalog changes require Admin, runtime actions require configured authority and successful gates.

01 / Investigate a service

Before you begin: Select the correct service and environment.

1. Open Live Operations

Read active impact, runtime agent, Network Sentinel, host posture and heartbeat. Check timestamps; no signal/unknown is not healthy.

2. Inspect signals and logs

Open the signal explorer and log-tail/evidence controls offered by the contract. Set the relevant scope and refresh. Compare runtime observations with external probes and incident history.

How to confirm success

You can identify the source and age of each observation.

Stop and check

Log excerpts can contain sensitive operational data; share only the necessary evidence.

02 / Create or update a service contract

Before you begin: Have the stable identity, owner, environment, bindings and approved endpoints.

1. Open Contract Configuration

Create a service or edit the selected contract. Set its identity/type, ownership, agent/network bindings, observation settings and certification stage.

2. Set valid control routes

Supply only approved extraction, formatting, shipping, diagnostics and control endpoints exposed by the editor. Review timeout/safety settings and associated cluster routing.

3. Save and validate

Save and inspect fresh evidence from the service. Delete only retired contracts after reviewing the impact and confirmation. A saved endpoint is not a proven working endpoint.

How to confirm success

The persisted contract and live evidence describe the intended service.

Stop and check

Do not promote certification or enable control merely to make a button available.

03 / Start, stop or restart a service

Before you begin: Have change authority, verified service identity, current evidence and a justified action.

1. Open the Service Control Gate

From the service or incident choose Service Control. Read eligibility, readiness, allowlisted action and current runtime state. Request diagnostics first when required.

2. Request and verify the challenge

Choose the intended action and provide the required reason. Request the OTP challenge. Check the action/service again before entering the issued one-time code.

3. Follow the result

Submit once and inspect command outcome and fresh service state. If blocked, expired or uncertain, read the reason and reconcile before a new request.

How to confirm success

A command has an attributable result, supported by refreshed runtime evidence.

Stop and check

Never treat STOP/RESTART as a harmless probe or reuse an expired challenge.

Something is blocking you?

Control blocked

Read the gate: readiness, certification, allowlist, cooldown or missing evidence must be resolved legitimately.

Stale heartbeat

Check the agent and telemetry route before treating the runtime state as current.

Terms in plain language

Contract

The saved identity, bindings and allowed operations for one service.

OTP

A one-time code that confirms the requested controlled action.

Procedure reference: nexus.services / 2026-10-30

NEXUS

Agent monitoring

Inspect the runtime agents that report service evidence and carry allowed commands.

Where to go: /nexus?workspace=agents

Access and authority

Agent monitoring access; onboarding credentials and catalog edits have separate controls.

01 / Investigate an agent

Before you begin: Know the host/agent expected to report the service.

1. Open the agent

Select it in Agents. Read identity, environment, heartbeat age and reported capabilities/linked services.

2. Correlate the gap

Compare agent freshness with the service's external Network Sentinel checks. If heartbeat is stale, inspect deployment/connectivity through the responsible owner.

3. Verify recovery

Refresh after the owner restores reporting and confirm a new heartbeat and service evidence.

How to confirm success

The agent's presence and capabilities are backed by recent observations.

Stop and check

An installed agent is not necessarily connected, and its existence does not authorize arbitrary shell commands.

Something is blocking you?

Agent missing

Verify deployment, identity and token configuration with the host owner using Onboarding. Do not publish tokens in incident notes.

Terms in plain language

Heartbeat

A periodic signal that the agent is still reporting.

Allowlist

The explicit set of permitted commands.

Procedure reference: nexus.agents / 2026-10-30

NEXUS

Database fabric

Represent databases and inspect their connectivity, usage and dependent services.

Where to go: /nexus?workspace=databases

Access and authority

Database fabric access; contract/connection changes require Admin.

01 / Inspect or configure database fabric

Before you begin: Know the database identity, environment, owner and approved connection profile.

1. Open the database

Select its fabric entry and review engine, schemas, connectivity and observed symptoms such as sessions, locks, lag or pool pressure where available.

2. Maintain the contract

Use configuration to set the intended database profile and access bindings. Enter required connection fields securely; preserve correct schema/environment mappings.

3. Test and verify

Use the connection test where offered. Read its result and refresh evidence. A successful connection test is not proof of application transaction success.

How to confirm success

The saved database contract and test result refer to the intended environment.

Stop and check

Do not infer that a database is down from one application's pool pressure or missing telemetry.

02 / Trace a database impact

Before you begin: Identify the affected application/service.

1. Follow its relationships

Review connected services and the dependency topology. Distinguish a dependency declared in the catalog from evidence of a current failure.

2. Escalate with scope

Capture database, schema, dependent service, timestamps and observed error. Use the incident workflow for response ownership.

How to confirm success

The escalation identifies the affected path and supporting signal.

Stop and check

Catalog visibility is not permission to change database data.

Something is blocking you?

Connection test fails

Read the error, confirm environment/endpoint and ask the database owner to verify approved credentials/network access.

Terms in plain language

Pool pressure

An application's demand for available database connections.

Procedure reference: nexus.databases / 2026-10-30

NEXUS

Service clusters

Group services and inspect the shared routing paths used by a cluster.

Where to go: /nexus?workspace=clusters

Access and authority

Cluster access; create/edit/delete require Admin.

01 / Explore a cluster

Before you begin: Know the affected service group.

1. Open Fabric Preview

Select the cluster and inspect entry points, service mesh, membership, routing readiness and ownership.

2. Follow the route

Trace the service path and inspect missing diagnostics or other route indicators. Open the relevant service to verify runtime evidence.

How to confirm success

You understand which services and routes form the cluster.

Stop and check

A drawn connection describes configuration; it is not proof that traffic is currently flowing.

02 / Maintain cluster membership and routes

Before you begin: Have the approved service grouping and endpoint contracts.

1. Open Configuration

Create or edit the cluster identity, owner, environment and service/entry membership.

2. Set routing and save

Review extraction, formatting, shipping, diagnostics and restart routing fields offered by the editor. Save and revisit Fabric Preview for missing routes. Delete only retired clusters after confirmation.

How to confirm success

The preview matches the saved membership and intended routes.

Stop and check

Do not change a shared route without checking all member services that depend on it.

Something is blocking you?

Missing route

Have the owner supply the approved endpoint; do not substitute an unrelated working URL.

Terms in plain language

Entry point

A service at the beginning of the cluster's path.

Procedure reference: nexus.clusters / 2026-10-30

NEXUS

Business flows

Describe a business journey so incident impact follows the user's actual service path.

Where to go: /nexus?workspace=flows

Access and authority

Business flows access; create/edit/delete require Admin.

01 / Follow a business journey

Before you begin: Know the business outcome and participating services.

1. Open the flow

Select the journey and inspect ordered service steps, entry/outcome and current evidence correlation.

2. Read impact in context

Check required versus optional steps and the affected path. Open linked incidents/services for evidence rather than interpreting all catalog dependencies as impacted.

How to confirm success

You can explain which step prevents the business outcome.

Stop and check

An optional service failure may not stop the whole journey; verify the flow's declared rules.

02 / Create or maintain a flow

Before you begin: Have the process owner's approved step sequence.

1. Configure the journey

Create/edit name, ownership and ordered service steps. Set required/optional behavior and the fields the editor requires.

2. Save and inspect

Review the rendered journey after saving. Remove obsolete flows only after confirming that incident correlation no longer needs them.

How to confirm success

The visual journey reflects the approved sequence and scope.

Stop and check

Incorrect flow membership can mislead business-impact calculations.

Something is blocking you?

Unexpected impact

Inspect the flow's service order and required flags before accepting the inferred impact.

Terms in plain language

Required step

A step necessary for the declared business outcome.

Procedure reference: nexus.flows / 2026-10-30

NEXUS

Dependency topology

Define and inspect directed relationships between services.

Where to go: /nexus?workspace=dependencies

Access and authority

Dependency topology access; changes require Admin.

01 / Read a dependency path

Before you begin: Identify the affected service and business flow.

1. Inspect direction

Open Dependencies and select the relationship. Read from/to services, purpose/type, scope and any evidence hints.

2. Compare live evidence

Trace upstream/downstream effects and check the related incident/service. Distinguish a catalog edge from an observed failure.

How to confirm success

The investigation describes who depends on whom and why.

Stop and check

Reversing the direction can invert the suspected cause and impact.

02 / Maintain a dependency

Before you begin: Know both service identities and the actual interaction.

1. Configure the edge

Create/edit source and target, purpose, scope and available timeout/failure hints. Use flow-scoped relationships when appropriate.

2. Save and validate

Inspect topology and affected flow after saving. Delete only obsolete relationships after reviewing the confirmation.

How to confirm success

The saved edge describes the real dependency and intended scope.

Stop and check

Do not add speculative relationships merely to force correlation.

Something is blocking you?

Graph looks wrong

Check source/target, flow scope and service identities before adjusting incident conclusions.

Terms in plain language

Directed edge

A relationship from one service to the service it uses.

Procedure reference: nexus.dependencies / 2026-10-30

NEXUS

Agent and service onboarding

Connect an agent/service through governed credentials and evidence-based readiness.

Where to go: /nexus?workspace=onboarding

Access and authority

Onboarding access; token and catalog operations require the relevant Admin authority.

01 / Onboard an agent and service

Before you begin: Have the target host, owner, environment and approved deployment plan.

1. Review readiness

Open Onboarding and inspect missing contracts, bindings, agent credentials and readiness requirements. Identify the specific service/host.

2. Provision securely

Use the offered agent-token controls only with authority. Copy a newly issued token into the approved agent configuration through the deployment owner; never place it in tickets or screenshots.

3. Register and observe

Create/bind the service contract, deploy the configured agent and verify fresh heartbeat/telemetry. Progress certification only when the required observation/diagnostic/control evidence is proven.

How to confirm success

The service is mapped to an agent and reports fresh evidence at the justified readiness stage.

Stop and check

Token generation alone is not onboarding completion. Rotation can invalidate deployed credentials; coordinate the rollout.

02 / Review or rotate an agent token

Before you begin: Know the active agents using the credential and the replacement plan.

1. Inspect current status

Read the current token status without exposing its secret. Identify the authorized rotation/generation control.

2. Coordinate the change

Issue the replacement only under the approved plan, update agent configurations and verify reporting resumes. Treat a one-time display as sensitive.

How to confirm success

Expected agents report successfully using the approved credential.

Stop and check

Do not rotate during an incident without considering the effect on current telemetry.

Something is blocking you?

Agent still absent

Check endpoint, token and host connectivity with the deployment owner; do not repeatedly issue new credentials.

Terms in plain language

Certification

The recorded readiness stage justified by observed capabilities and tests.

Procedure reference: nexus.onboarding / 2026-10-30

NEXUS

Environment rollover

Prepare, test and execute a governed environment change with explicit scope and proof.

Where to go: /nexus?workspace=rollover

Access and authority

Environment rollover access; configuration and execution are role- and challenge-gated.

01 / Configure and test a rollover

Before you begin: Have an approved source/target environment and change plan.

1. Review the environment contract

Create/edit the intended environment, connection profiles, schemas and replacement rules. Check each source value and target value; empty or wrong targets can affect the wrong environment.

2. Test connections

Run the available environment and schema connection tests. Inspect results for every required connection. Saving a profile is not a successful test.

3. Review the execution scope

Read the current assessment/test evidence and intended changes before requesting authorization. Save changes, then repeat affected tests.

How to confirm success

The saved contract and fresh tests support the exact planned change.

Stop and check

Do not proceed with missing targets, ambiguous replacements or failed tests.

02 / Authorize and follow a rollover

Before you begin: Have the approved change window, fresh tests, reason and rollback/recovery owner.

1. Request the challenge

Select the intended action and review source/target and scope. Request the one-time-code challenge only when the gates permit it.

2. Confirm once

Enter the issued code for that challenge and execute once. Follow execution history and detailed outcomes rather than assuming the request succeeded.

3. Verify and follow up

Check target connectivity and application behavior through the approved change procedure. Review/set available reminders for follow-up and acknowledge them appropriately.

How to confirm success

Execution history and post-change checks show what actually changed.

Stop and check

If completion is uncertain, stop and verify actual state before retrying. A test does not perform the rollover.

03 / Manage obsolete contracts and reminders

Before you begin: Confirm the environment is no longer in operational use.

1. Review dependencies and history

Inspect the selected environment and existing execution/reminder records.

2. Use the provided control

Edit reminders or delete an obsolete contract only where allowed and after reading the confirmation. Verify the resulting list.

How to confirm success

The active configuration reflects the approved inventory.

Stop and check

Do not delete a contract to hide failed execution evidence.

Something is blocking you?

OTP expired or gate blocked

Correct the failed prerequisite and request a fresh challenge for the same verified scope.

Test failure

Review the exact schema/connection result with the owner; do not weaken controls to continue.

Terms in plain language

Rollover

A controlled change from one environment/configuration to another.

Procedure reference: nexus.rollover / 2026-10-30

NEXUS

Procedure library

Find, maintain and govern operational procedures used by operators and Copilot.

Where to go: /nexus?workspace=sops

Access and authority

Procedure library access; registry changes and approval require the relevant Admin authority.

01 / Find the applicable procedure

Before you begin: Know the service, incident or operational task.

1. Search the library

Inspect the procedure title, scope, version/status and content. Distinguish indexed material from a managed registry record.

2. Use with current evidence

Read prerequisites, steps and stop rules. In SOP Copilot, verify the cited source and version before acting. A recommendation does not authorize a control action.

How to confirm success

You have the correct procedure for the service and current task.

Stop and check

Do not execute an outdated or unapproved instruction because it was retrieved by search.

02 / Adopt, edit or approve a procedure

Before you begin: Have the owner-approved procedure and governance authority.

1. Adopt when necessary

For indexed-only material, use Adopt to create the managed record before editing/approving it. Inspect imported metadata and content.

2. Revise the contract

Update the applicable service/scope, version, steps, prerequisites and other required fields in Governed SOP Contract. Save and inspect the managed record.

3. Govern the status

Apply the available approval/status controls only after review. Delete only obsolete managed records after checking the impact and confirmation.

How to confirm success

The managed procedure has an attributable current version and governance state.

Stop and check

Indexed availability is not the same as approval. Editing a registry record is not proof that all external source documents changed.

Something is blocking you?

Cannot edit indexed SOP

Adopt it into the managed registry using the allowed action, then review it.

Terms in plain language

Indexed

Available for retrieval/search.

Managed

Tracked in the editable, governed procedure registry.

Procedure reference: nexus.sops / 2026-10-30